



Office of Graduate Admissions for the College
of Education and Communication Graduate
Admissions Assistants Guide to Slate

Version 1.0

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Introduction

As part of DePaul University's Office of Graduate Admission for the College of Education and Communication, one of the main priorities is to promote the College of Education and Communications programs. One tool integral to this is a record system called Slate (also known as "Blue Demon Domain"). Slate is a customer relationship management (CRM) software used throughout DePaul University (across all of the colleges within the university) to manage recruitment and enrollment.

Accessible to prospective and current students, Slate can be used for the following:

- Getting in contact with DePaul University's Office of Graduate Admission
- Getting information on any programs that they are interested in
- Making an appointment with Admissions Counselors
- Enrolling in any events
- Submitting an application and any needed, application materials
- Checking the status of an application
- And more!

Employees are expected to use Slate in day-to-day operations to assist in supporting prospective/current students. With over 28 different general programs of study and 46 specialty areas/program, 1 dual degree program with 8 licensures to choose from, 4 initial teaching licensures, 15 endorsements, 3 professional specialization programs and 5 certificates and credentials available between the College of Education and Communications, this system is integral in making education accessible to all and in day-to-day operations within the Office of Graduate Admission.

Purpose

This document will guide DePaul University's Office of Graduate Admission for the College of Education and Communication Graduate Admissions Assistants (GAAs), Interns and other Student Employees through the basics and how to use the Slate platform.

About Slate

Confidentiality (Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act and the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act)

As an employee within the Office of Graduate Admission that has access to Slate which houses personal information, it is imperative that all employees maintain confidentiality as it relates to the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) and the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA).

All employees are required to take training for HIPAA and FERPA within the first week of their employment and after that, annually. DePaul University takes adhere to these policies very seriously. Failure to adhere to either of them will result in immediate employee termination and a possible fine or jail time. Any questions related to HIPAA and FERPA should be directed to your supervisor.

What is the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act?

Taken from DePaul University's Vice President of Information Services Report (2016)¹

All employees at DePaul University are expected to abide by the federal Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) which "protects the security and privacy of all individually identifiable health information" as DePaul University is "a covered entity that creates, receives, maintains and/or transmits personal health information as a health care provider, as part of health plans, and/or in other related roles involving health information, within the areas identified as the health care components of the organization."

What is the Family Education Rights and Privacy Act?

Established in 1974, this federal law protects the privacy of student education records. Students are afforded the following rights:

1. The Right to Inspect Education Records
2. The Right to Request Amendment of Education Records
3. The Right to Consent to Disclosures
4. The Right to File a Complaint Under FERPA

More information on FERPA can be found on the [U.S. Department of Education FERPA website](#) and [OneDePaul FERPA website](#).

¹ DePaul University's Vice President of Information Services. (2016). Health Information Security & Privacy [Review of Health Information Security & Privacy]. In DePaul University's Information Services Department (Ed.), DePaul University (p. 4). DePaul University.
<https://offices.depaul.edu/secretary/policies-procedures/policies/Documents/Health%20Information%20Security.pdf>

Accessing and Logging Into Slate

How Do I Access Slate?

Slate can be accessed on any electronic device that has the ability to connect to Wi-Fi. All part time and full time employees will receive access within the first week of their employment to the employee view of Slate. Reference the [How to Login to Slate](#) section of this document for information on how to login to Slate.

Slate can be accessed through any of the following methods:

- On a web browser through the [Slate website](#).
- Through the Slate mobile application (on a cellular device or the department's iPads).

How Do I Login to Slate?

1. On any Internet browser, navigate to the [Slate website](#) or download and open the Slate mobile application.

- For employees who are accessing Slate for the first time, it is recommended to use a computer rather than a mobile device.

2. Enter in the employee's DePaul Campus Connect credentials as the "User ID" and "Password" on the Slate Login page. Reference **Figure 1** below for the DePaul University Slate Login page.

- Depending on the employee's student status:
 - If the employee is a current student:
 - Enter in your DePaul Campus Connect credentials.
 - DePaul University's Help Desk will have enabled employee access to the current student's Campus Connect account.
 - If the employee is not a current student:
 - Follow guidance provided by Help Desk and your supervisor to create a Campus Connect account.
 - Help Desk can be contacted at 312-362-8765 or through email at helpdesk@depaul.edu.
 - Once those that have been created, move to the next step.

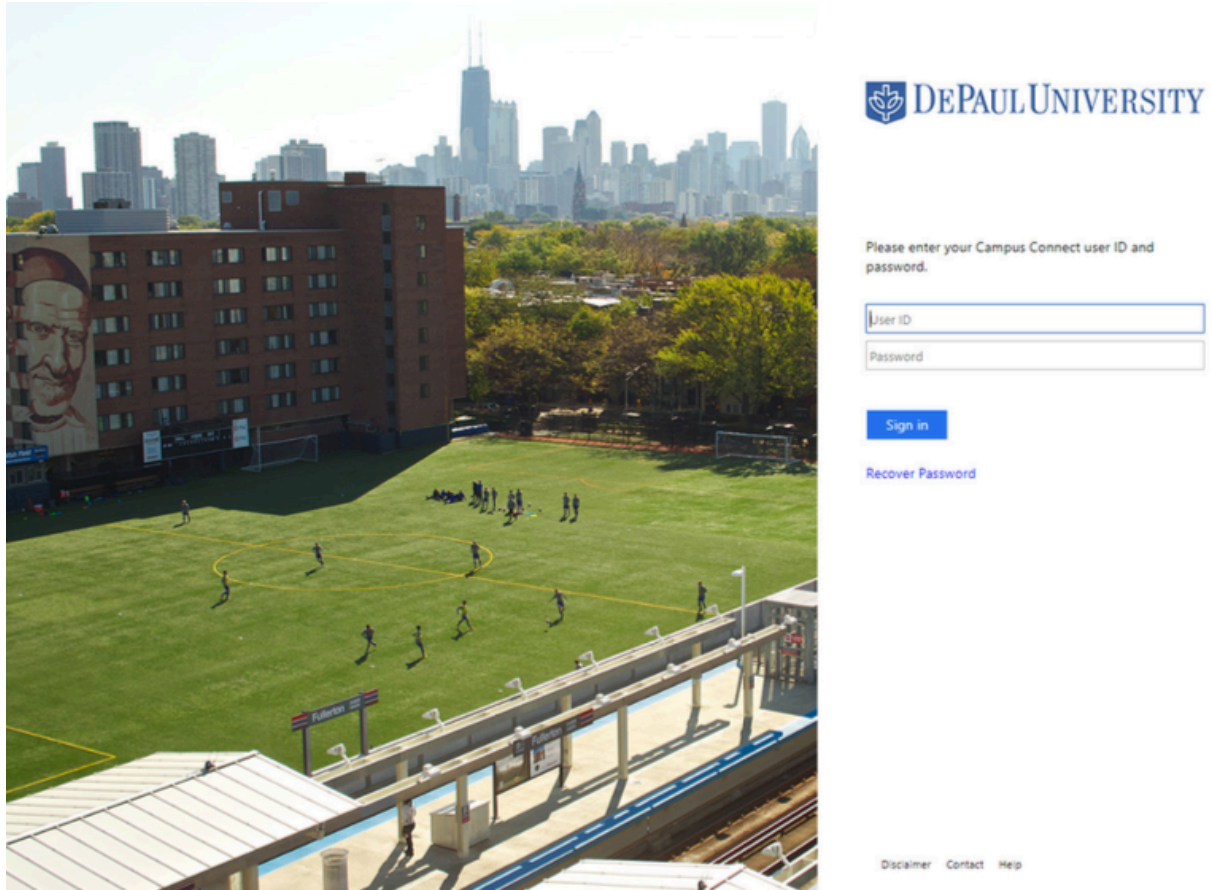


Figure 1: Slate DePaul University Campus Connect Logins

3. Once employees have logged in successfully, they will be taken to Slate's Dashboard Homepage.

- Employees should see a welcome message on the left side of the page and have their employee profile with their first and last name on the top right side of the page.

About Slate Dashboard Homepage

After logging into Slate, the first page that will be shown is the homepage. Reference **Figure 2** below for a view of this homepage.

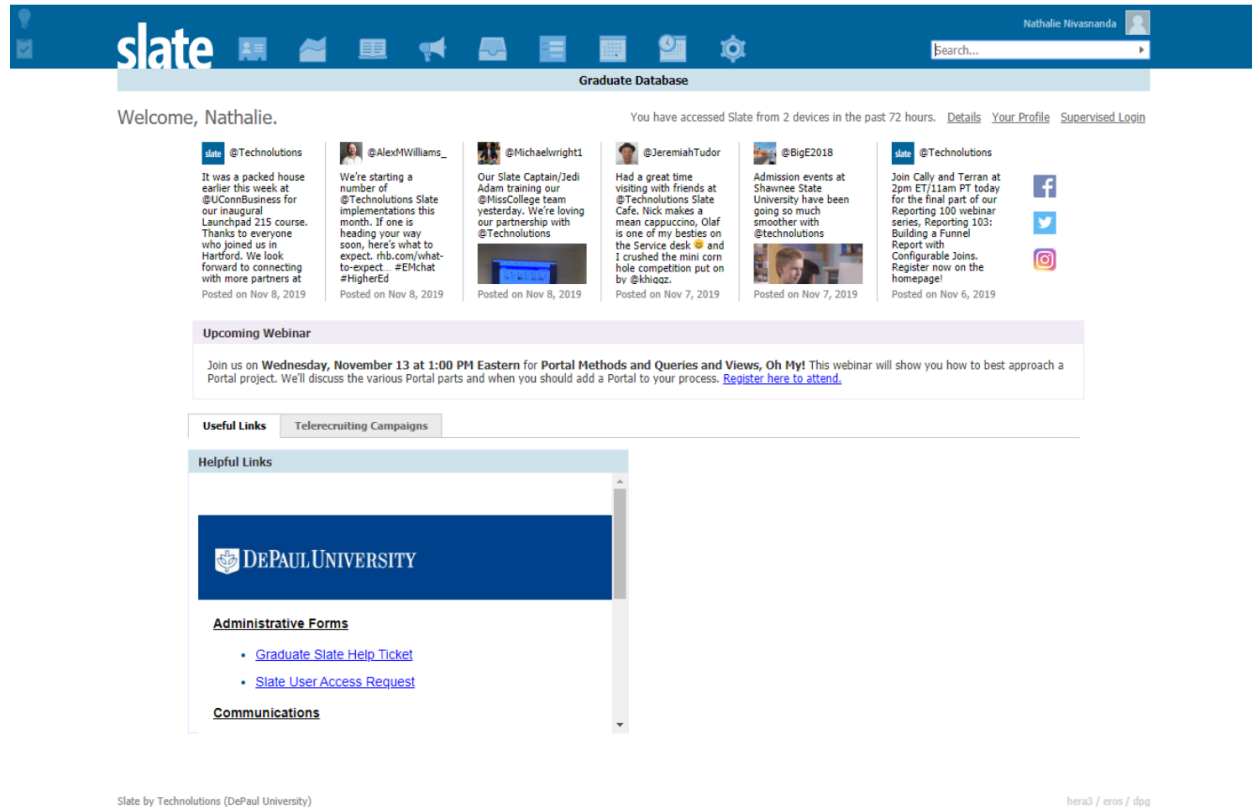


Figure 2: Slate Dashboard Homepage

The homepage consists of:

- 9 header icons that can be used as shortcuts on actions in Slate
 - Reference the [Header Icons on Slate](#) section of this document for more information.
- A search bar to look up any prospective or current student's profile
- A welcome message
- Any trending stories on Slate
- Any upcoming webinars
- 2 tabs
 - Helpful Links
 - Telerecruiting Campaigns

Header Icons on Slate

Slate will have a header row that consists of nine icons. Reference **Figure 3** below for these icons.



Figure 3: Slate Icons

Not all of the icons available here will be accessible to the GAA's. GAA's are not allowed full access to Slate, the following employees that are allowed full access to Slate are:

- Directors
- Assistant Directors
- Event and Office Manager
- Graduate Interns

The icons that have an "*" symbol in this section, represent icons that a GAA will need to use in their position. Below are each of the icons and more information about them:

Record Search



This quick access tool will keep track of the last 10 Slate profiles that have been searched and opened. If GAA's need to go back to a previously accessed Slate record/profile, they can easily do so here.

Figure 4: Record Search Icon

Query



This icon builds and runs queries to find Slate data. GAA's do not have access to this.

Figure 5: Query Icon

Slate Reader



This icon is used in reviewing applications. GAA's do not have access to this.

Figure 6: Slate Reader Ico

Deliver

Used in sending system-generated email campaigns, GAA's will not be able to select this icon.



Figure 7: Deliver Icon

Inbox*



This icon stores all email communications for prospective students who have opted in to receive emails from edgradadmissions@depaul.edu and grad-com@depaul.edu.

Figure 8: Inbox Icon

Forms



This icon holds all information that has been entered in about a prospective student or that the prospective student has entered in themselves on their Student Portal. GAA's do not have access to this.

Figure 9: Forms Icon

Events/Trips*



This icon shows the event schedule for the whole department. GAA's can use this icon to view and prepare for upcoming events, see attendance lists for each event and add/remove attendees.

Figure 10: Events/Trips Icon

Scheduler*



This icon shows all scheduled one-on-one in-person and phone appointments that prospective students have registered for. GAA's can create, edit and delete one-on-one appointments using this Scheduler.

Figure 11: Scheduler Icon

Database



This icon directs to the Slate Help Community Message Boards.

Figure 12: Database Icon

How to Find a Prospective Student's Record/Profile

1. On the right side of the Slate header, locate the search bar.
 - a. Reference **Figure 13** below for a view of the empty search bar.



Figure 13: Slate Search Bar

2. Prospective students can be located in Slate in a number of different ways. Some ways to search for a prospective student include entering in:
 - a. The student's first and last name
 - b. A phone number
 - c. An email
 - d. An Applicant's ID number
 - i. Each prospective student is given a unique 9 digit code by Slate to help identify them in Slate systems.
3. Enter the prospective student's information into the search bar. This will result in a drop down menu.
 - a. Selecting any of the entries in that dropdown will route directly to their Slate record/profile.
 - i. There may be times where there will be multiple entries for a prospective student so it is important to double check that you have located the right person.
 1. Using "Nathalie Nivasnanda" as an example (reference **Figure 14** below), there are two separate profiles that have been created so it's important that the right profile is selected.

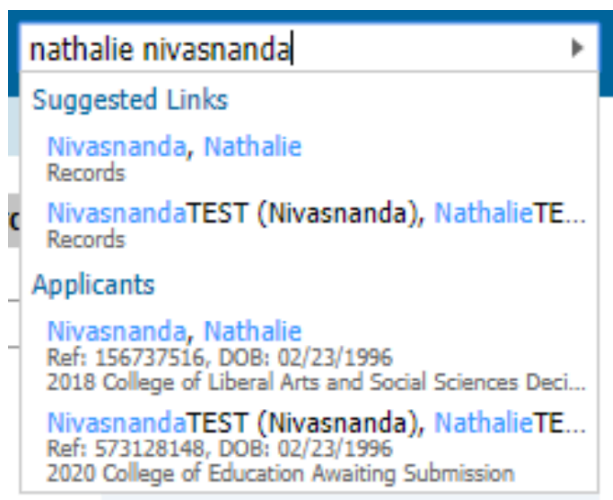


Figure 14: Student Record/Profile Drop Down Menu

- b. Another way to locate a prospective student's profile is to enter in the prospective student's information and select "Enter."

- i. Slate will display a list of results in a “Lookup” screen.
- ii. Reference **Figure 15** below for an example of a “Lookup” Screen.

Lookup

New Record

Partial Match

nathalie nivasnanda

Matching Rows

2

Filters

Filter

NOT

(

OR

)

Name	Birthdate	Email	Application
Nivasnanda, Nathalie	02/23/1996	nnivasna@depaul.edu	
NivasnandaTEST (Nivasnanda), NathalieTEST (Nathalie)	02/23/1996	nnivasna@depaul.edu	2020 College of Education

Lookup

[Organizations](#)

Figure 15: Student Record/Profile Lookup Screen

Reviewing a Prospective Student's Record

Now that the GAAs know how to find a prospective student's record/profile, it is important to know how to read a student's record/profile. Each prospective student's record/profile will look different but generally consists of at least 4-9 tabs:

1. [Dashboard](#)
2. [Timeline](#)
3. Any [Application\(s\)](#) (current or previous)
 - a. Note: This will only be a tab if the prospective student has started an application.
 - b. Every application that has been opened will have a separate tab. Students are only allowed to have 4 open applications available at one time.
 - c. If the student has submitted an application in previous years, there will be a tab created for that application.
4. [Profile](#)
5. [Materials](#)
6. [Student Information](#)

Reference **Figure 16** below for the five standard Slate record/profile tabs. In this specific example, the prospective student has not started any applications so there are no application tabs.

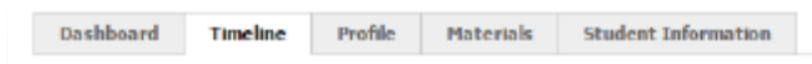


Figure 16: Five Standard Student Record/Profile Tabs

Dashboard

When opening a prospective student's Slate record/profile, it will route to the student's Dashboard. This dashboard contains information that the prospective student has entered in on their Student Portal or has been automatically entered based on information given to Slate. Reference **Figure 17** below for a view of a prospective student's Slate record/profile.

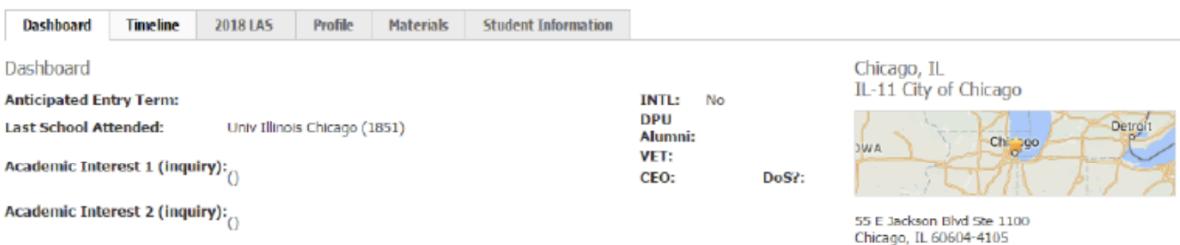


Figure 17: Student Record/Profile Dashboard Tab

This tab includes:

- Anticipated entry term
- List of schools previously attended
- Academic inquiries
- Whether or not the student is a DePaul University alumni
- Contact information
- Mailing address

Not all prospective students will provide all of the above information so some records/profiles may have blank entries. **Figure 17** above displays a prospective student's profile that has not entered in a lot of information about themselves as the only information that can be seen is the list of schools previously attended and the student's address.

Timeline

This tab will contain all interactions that a prospective student has had with DePaul University Office of Graduate Admission. This can be viewed in two ways:

- [Timeline View](#)
- [Interaction View](#)

Views

Using the Timeline View

The view will show the prospective student and Office of Graduate Admission interaction based on when they happened. A bar graph will be organized by month with a snapshot of the prospective student's activity and below that, is a list of interactions between the prospective student and DePaul University. Each interaction can be selected, if an employee is wanting more context to what a specific interaction was about.

In **Figure 18** below, the bar for May 2017 is larger than the other months because the prospective student made a phone call to the Office of Graduate Admission, intake form updates and registered for an event.

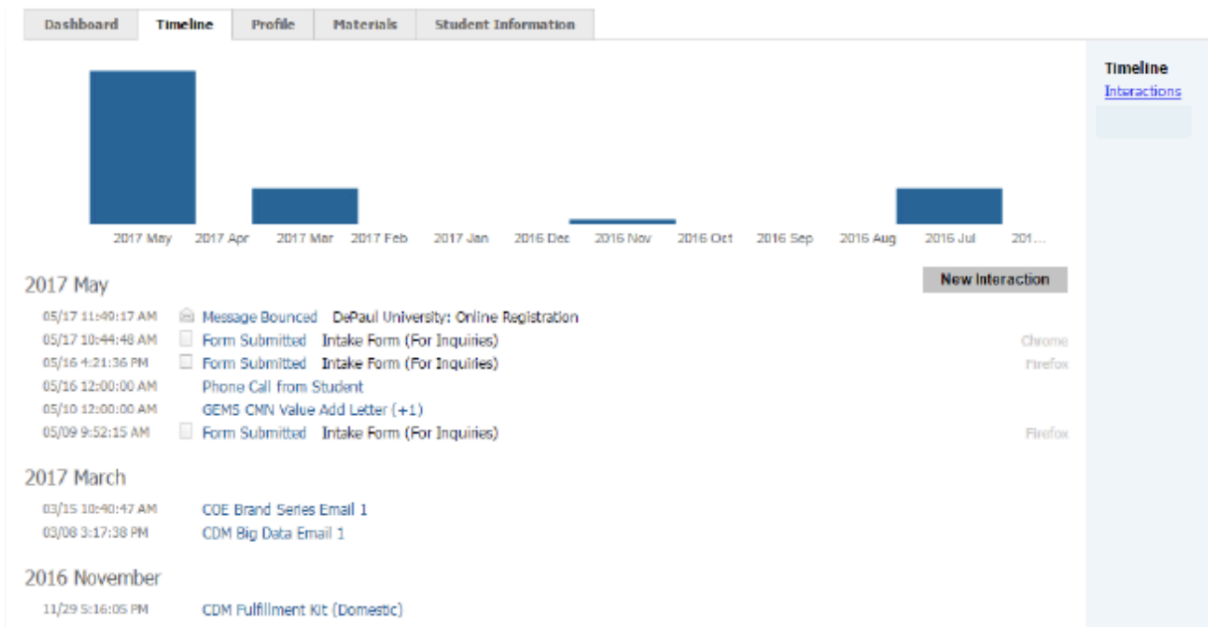


Figure 18: Slate Timeline Tab

Using the Interactive View

This view will list all interactions in a text format and organized by the MM/DD/YYYY of said interaction. In **Figure 19** below, each interaction will have code categorizations such as:

- Sources
 - These are all the times that a prospective student's data is entered and updated in Slate.
 - This will include times that the prospective student has updated their own information or if the Office of Graduate Admissions has gone in and updated the prospective student's information.
- Message
 - These are all email and SMS communications sent to and received by the prospective student to the Office of Graduate Admissions.
- Mailing
 - All mail and telerecruiting items that have been sent from the Office of Graduate Admissions to the prospective student are considered "Mailing."
- Contact
 - When prospective students have made phone calls to this office, Slate classifies this as a "Contact." These types of interactions will need to be created manually by employees within the Office of Graduate Admissions as Slate is not connected to the Office of Graduate Admissions phones.

Dashboard

Timeline

Profile

Materials

Student Information

Date ▲	Code	Subject	User/Status
New Interaction			
05/17/2017	Message	/account/register DePaul University: Online Registration	Bounced 
05/17/2017	Source	Intake Form (For Inquiries)	
05/16/2017	Source	Intake Form (For Inquiries)	
05/16/2017	Contact	Phone Call from Student	
05/10/2017	Mailing	GEMS CMN Value Add Letter	
05/10/2017	Mailing	GEMS CMN Value Add Letter	
05/09/2017	Source	Intake Form	
05/09/2017	Source	Intake Form (For Inquiries)	

[Timeline Interactions](#)

☒ Messages

☒ Sources

☒ Interactions

☒ Contact

☒ Historical Communications

☒ Mailing

Figure 19: Slate Timeline Interactive Tab

How to Update a Prospective Student's Record/Profile Timeline

GAAs are expected to document all interactions a prospective student has made to the Office of Graduate Admissions. If prospective students have reached out to the Office of Graduate Admissions via the live chat feature or email (edgradadmissions@depaul.edu or grad-com@depaul.edu), Slate will automatically track that and enter it into the prospective student's timeline. Phone calls will need to be added to the timeline manually and are not tracked in Slate.

It is important to track all interactions with a prospective student because it can assist with future live chats, emails or phone calls that the prospective student places. Instead of having a prospective student explain their previous issues again, employees can search up their record and read through what happened and how that was resolved to the prospective student.

Process Flow

Recording an interaction involves 2 parties (Prospective Student and the GAA). The primary party responsible for recording this will be the GAA. This process flow will start with the prospective student making contact with the office and ends with the GAA saving the interaction into the prospective student's profile.

Reference **Figure 20** below for a process flow of how to record an interaction in Slate when a prospective student contacts DePaul University's Office of Graduate Admission.

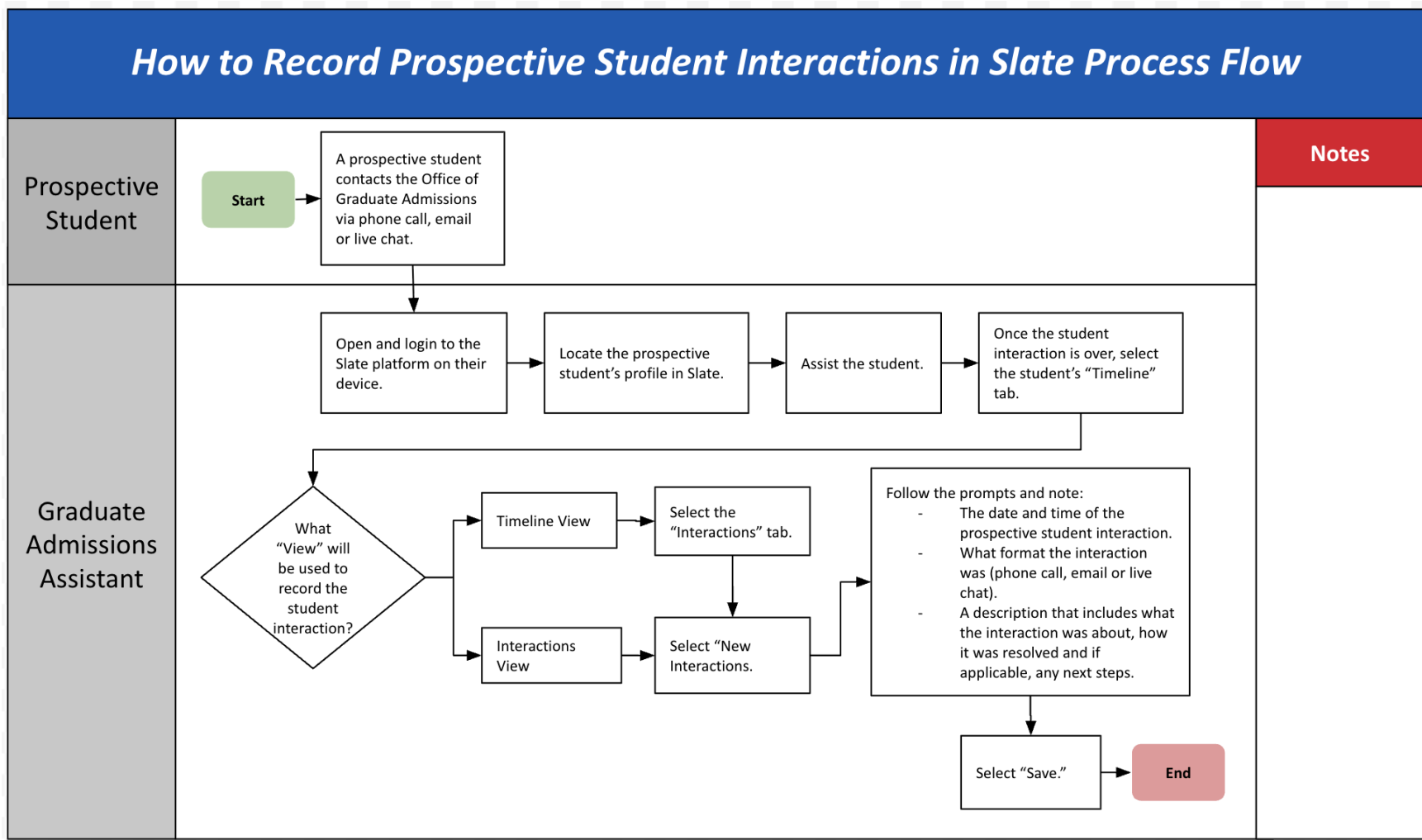


Figure 20: How to Record Prospective Student Interactions in Slate Process Flow

Application(s)

The Application tab displays each application a prospective student has started. The application tab follows the format of “YEAR” and the acronym for the school to which the prospective student is applying for. As an example: a student applying for a College of Education and College of Communication programs for the Winter 2026, will have tabs that read: “2026 COE” and “2026 CMN”.

Prospective students can have up to 4 open applications at one time. GAA’s should only focus on any “COE” and “CMN” applications. Any applications that do not have this acronym belong to a different department.

Each application will display the following:

- Application Status
 - Towards the left side of this tab, the status of the application will be present with terms such as “In Progress” and “Completed” and indicates whether or not the prospective student has submitted their application or if they are still in the process of completing it.
 - If a prospective student has submitted their application, the decision status will indicate where the application currently is and if a decision has been made from the admission team.
- Current Bin
 - For applications that have not been submitted but are pending materials, this will indicate what admission team will review this application.
 - Applications for the College of Education and Communication will have “COE Awaiting Submission” and “CMN Awaiting Submission.”
- Last Updated/Submitted
 - These are the dates that the application was last updated and submitted.
- Program and Term
 - This is the program a prospective student is applying for and the term for this particular application.
- Required Materials Checklist
 - The rest of this tab is a checklist of the required materials that the student has/still needs to submit.
 - The required materials will vary based on the prospective student, what quarter they are applying for and the program they are applying for as each program has different requirements.
 - This checklist has 3 different symbols for each item on the checklist:
 - Red “X”
 - This means that those materials are outstanding. Prospective students will need to submit these documents prior to their application being reviewed by the admission team.
 - Once all the red “X”s are gone from this checklist, the application and all materials will be sent to the admission team for a decision.
 - Green Check Mark
 - This means that those materials have been received and have been entered into the prospective student’s record/profile.
 - No further action related to that checklist item is needed.
 - Gray Check Mark

- This means that the specific materials are not needed by the prospective student and that it has been waived by the Office of Graduate Admissions.

Profile

The Profile tab contains biographical details related to a prospective student. Reference **Figure 21** below for a view of a prospective student's profile tab. Due to this figure having been taken from a prospective student's Slate profile, information has been blurred out to maintain privacy.

The screenshot displays the 'Profile' tab in a web application. At the top, there is a navigation bar with tabs: Dashboard, Timeline, 2018 IAS, Profile (selected), Materials, and Student Information. The main content area is divided into two columns. The left column contains sections for 'United States Citizen' (with 'White' below it), 'Address' (with a blurred address and 'Chicago, IL 60604-4105' below it), 'Contact' (with 'Email' and 'Phone' below it), and 'Academic History' (with 'Univ Illinois Chicago, Bachelor's, 05/2000', 'Psychology', and 'Chicago, IL' below it). The right column is a light blue sidebar titled 'Overview' containing a list of links: Biographical, Contact / Address, Relationships, Schools, Scores, Jobs, Courses, Interests, Sports, Account, Create Application, Restore Application, Edit Slate ID, and Edit Restricted Access.

Figure 21: Slate Record/Profile Profile Tab

The information covered here includes:

- Biographical*
 - This includes:
 - The student's full name
 - Gender
 - Birthdate
 - Citizenship
- Contact/address*
 - This includes:
 - Email
 - Phone
 - Mailing address
- Relationships
 - This includes:
 - A record of associated relations (parents, spouse, etc.)
- Schools*
 - This includes:

- All previously attended undergraduate programs and schools
 - All previously attended graduate programs and schools
- Scores
 - This includes:
 - Test score data
- Jobs
 - This includes:
 - Job employment history

Materials

The tab contains a record of all documents that have been submitted to the Office of Graduate Admissions. Once a prospective student has submitted or sent materials to our offices (such as letters of recommendation (LORs), unofficial and official transcripts, personal statements, and any additional documents needed for the application process), the Office of Graduate Admission staff will scan and upload materials to the prospective student's Slate record/profile.

Reference **Figure 22** below for a view of the Materials tab.

Dashboard	Timeline	2018 COE	2017 CSH	Profile	Materials	Student Information
Date ▲	Description	Record	User	Restore Material		
New Material						
05/22/2017	Slate Application at Submission	2018 COE				
05/17/2017	Resume	2017 CSH				
05/17/2017	Transcripts (student copy)	2017 CSH				

Figure 22: Slate Record/Profile Materials Tab

Once the materials have been scanned into Slate, a confirmation email will be sent to the prospective student to let them know their materials have been received and the item will be checked off on the prospective student's application.

GAAs do not have the ability to upload materials into Slate profiles. Only Directors, Assistant Directors and the Event and Office Manager have this ability. Any received materials will need to be stamped with a date that reflects the date the item was received, the prospective student's Slate ID written in pen and handed to the Event and Officer Manager who is responsible for scanning and uploading these materials to the prospective student's profile.

Every document that has been submitted by the prospective student and the Office of Graduate Admission staff will have:

- Date
 - This is the date that the document has been uploaded into Slate.
- Description
 - This will indicate what was uploaded to Slate. In **Figure 22** above, this prospective student has uploaded a copy of their transcript, resume and Slate application.

- Selecting each material under the “Description” column will display a copy of the document as it is in Slate.
- Record
 - Materials that have been uploaded into Slate will need to be connected to an application. Records will connect the uploaded materials to an application.
 - In **Figure 22**, the prospective student’s resume has been connected to the 2017 CSH application so the resume Record entry has “2017 CSH.”
- User
 - Depending on who uploaded materials:
 - If it’s been uploaded by the prospective student, the user will be blank.
 - If it’s been uploaded by the Office of Graduate Admission staff, the “User” will indicate the first and last name of the Office of Graduate Admission staff.

Student Information

The Student Information tab that contains information about the prospective student. Reference **Figure 23** below for a view of this tab.

Dashboard	Timeline	2018 COE	2017 CSH	Profile	Materials	Student Information
Academic Interest Data						
Student Type	New Graduate Student					
Entry Term						
Academic Interest 1	Educating Adults - MA					
Academic Interest 2	Public Health - MPH					
Previous Academic Interest(s)	Accountancy - MS Chemistry - MS Economic Policy Analysis - MS Educating Adults - MA Marketing - MS Public Health - MPH					
Combined Degree Flag	No					
Staff Assigned						
Communication Data						
Stop Communication	No Phone					
Student Data						
PeopleSoft ID	1896515					
Military Flag	DePaul Alum					
International Student Flag	No	International Student Flag - Manual Lock				
CEO Information						
CEO Cohort Interest	CEO Recruiter ID					

Figure 23: Slate Record/Profile Student Information Tab

Data displayed on this tab include:

- Academic Interest Data
 - This lists:
 - Study type
 - Entry term
 - Two primary academic interests

- Previous academic interests
 - Whether or not the student is a combined degree student
 - If the student has been assigned a staff member as a contact in the admissions process
- Communication Data
 - Some prospective students will indicate how they would like to be contacted
- Student Data
 - This lists:
 - The PeopleSoft ID number
 - If a prospective student has been accepted into a program, the PeopleSoft ID number will be the student's Campus Connect ID number
 - Whether or not the prospective student is an alumni of DePaul University
 - If the prospective student has been in the military
 - If the prospective student is part of a Cohort program

For Any Questions or Additional Help

If GAAs need further assistance or have any questions, they are encouraged to contact any of the following team members:

- Directors
- Assistant Directors
- Event and Office Manager

Document History

Table 1: Document History Details

Date	Details	Author
01/11/2026	Creation of this document.	Technical Writer